

[Return to Search](#)

The Gwi Bushmen

Author(S): Silberbauer, George B.

Document Type: Essay

Original Page: 310

Culture (OWC): [San \(FX10\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Southern Africa

Field Date: 1958-1966

Coverage Date: 1950-1966

Place Coverage

G/wi, Central Kalahari Game Reserve, Botswana

Section Title(S): SOCIAL ORDER

Relationships between kin are categorized as either joking (*ho:khwudi*) or avoidance (*gjiukxekxu*), and an individual distinguishes between those of his kin whom he should *!ao* (fear, respect) and those with whom he may "play." In general, avoidance is expressed by:

1. Not sitting close to the relative and avoiding bodily contact
2. Refraining from loud laughter or noisy conversation, taking care not to swear or to mention sexual or other intimate matters in the relative's hearing, and always speaking softly and politely to him or her
3. Not addressing an avoidance relative by his or her name, but using the honorific plural, aggregate gender pronoun instead



4. Not touching the avoidance relative's possessions without permission and not receiving or passing anything directly from or to the relative, but through the hand of an intermediary.

602
[Kin Relationships](#)

Human Relations Area Files
755 Prospect Street
New Haven, CT 06511

General Inquiries:  hraf@yale.edu

Issues and Bugs:  hraf-support@yale.edu



[Terms and Conditions](#) · [Accessibility](#) · [Cookie Policy](#)